

How a \$3,000 Idea Beat a \$300 Million Problem

T.L.D.R.

I designed the simulation, brand and launch campaign for a training program that turned a feared AI platform into an everyday habit. It was built in 7 weeks for \$3,000.

Won Several Awards

- 3 Brandon Hall in 2025
- Plus 1 Brandon Hall Silver in 2026
- Docebo's Best Employee Development

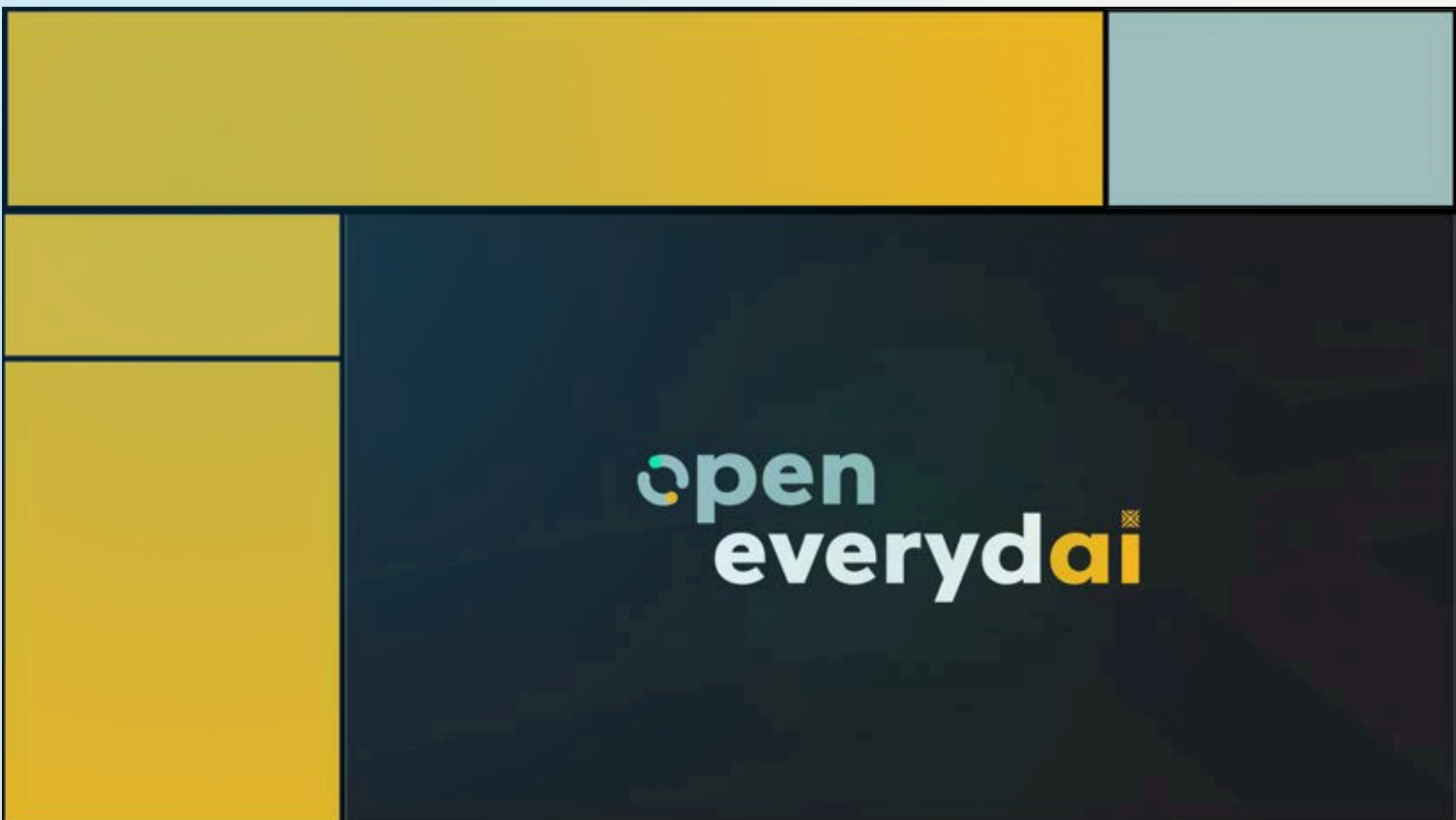
Role

Sole product and visual designer

on a six-person learning team, reporting to the Global VP of Learning.

Key Stakeholders

- VP, Global Head of Learning
- Global Manager of Learning & Development at VML



The Problem

A Fear of Being Replaced

A Behavior Problem, Not a Features Problem

Employees didn't fear the tool. They feared what it meant for their jobs. Slide decks and screen recordings couldn't fix that. People had to use the platform themselves, enough times that it stopped feeling foreign.

The Twist

Security rules blocked practice inside the real platform. So we built a simulation so accurate that users couldn't tell it apart from the real thing.

Design Decisions

Before

Original Simulation Theme



Square Screens

The original draft seemed more like something made for old school CRT monitors.

After

Redesigned Simulation Theme



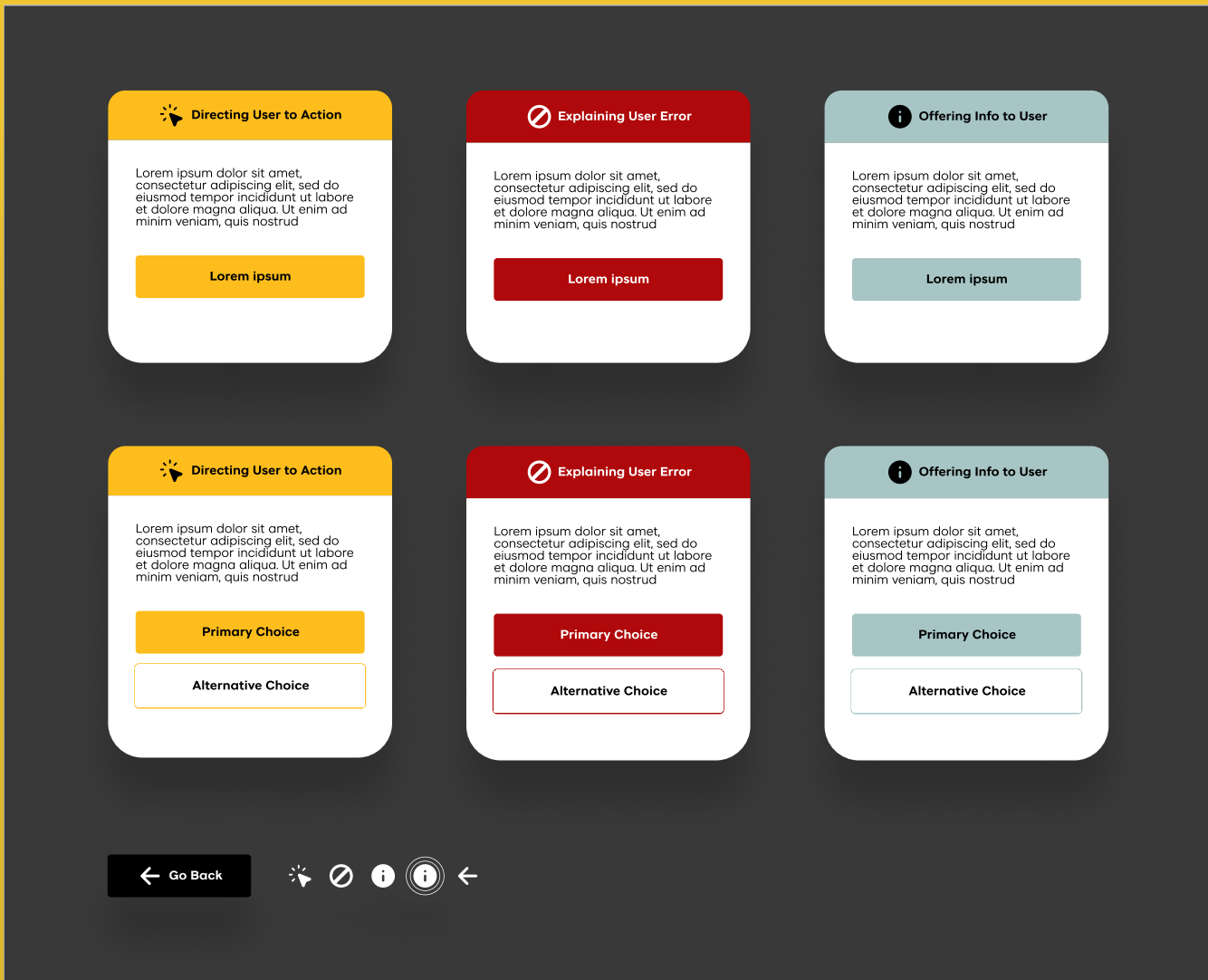
Widescreen

Widescreen, Guided and Modern
Matched screenshot by screenshot to the real platform.

Scaling

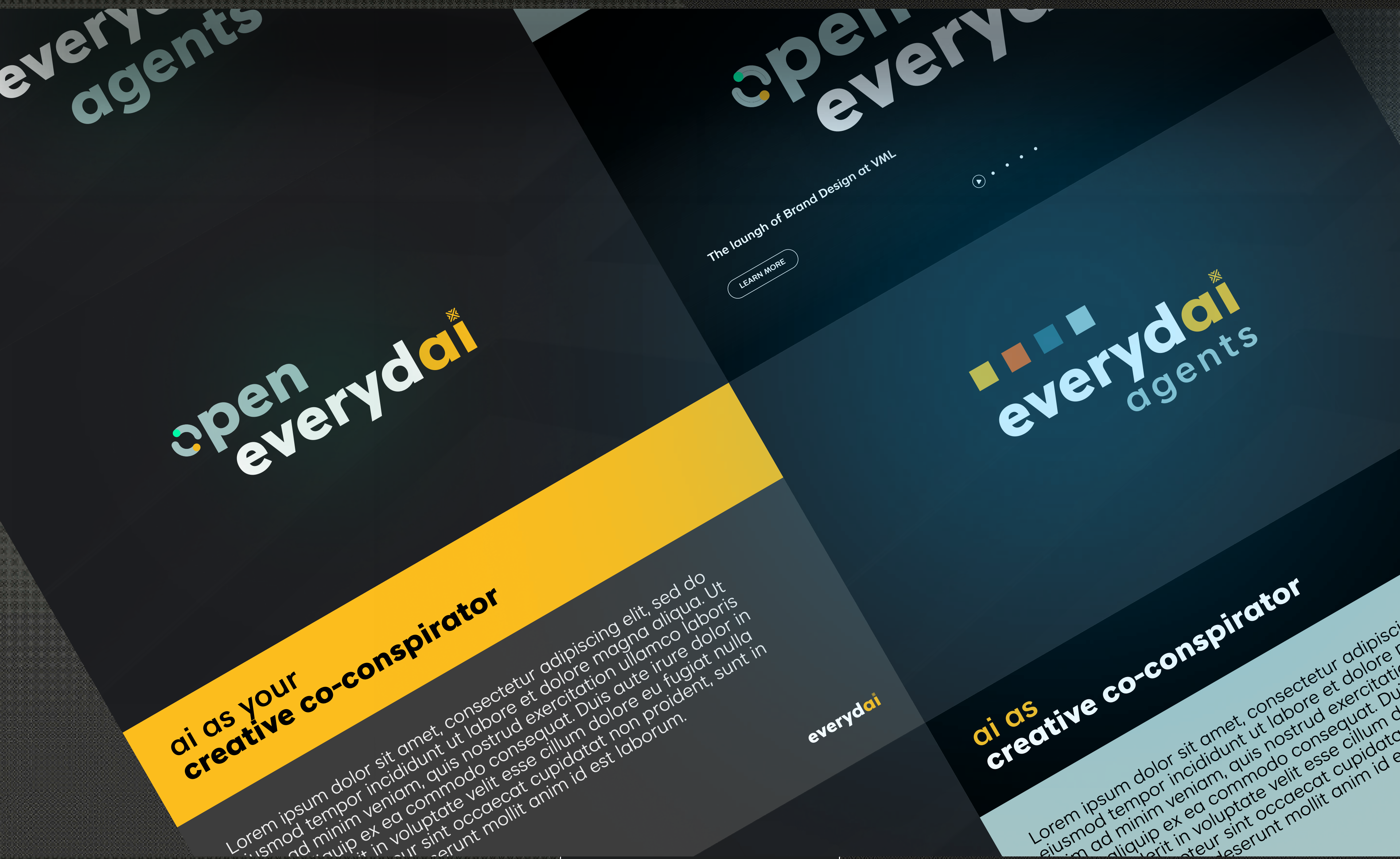
1 Coures Became 5

Five courses needed the same polished interactions. My insticint was to build out a prototype in Figma but teamwork makes the dream work. I packaged the dialogue boxes, triggers and navigation into software the team could also use. I made a reusable Storyline component library, plus a finished reference course. The Global Manager of L&D used it to build the other four.



The Brand Had to Disarm the Fear

Generic AI imagery looks like the threat people were worried about. I built a friendly icon system and carried it through every touchpoint. The palette (A cool, electric blue and yellow on dark backdrops) made the platform feel approachable, not corporate or threatening.



Reflections



Brandon Hall Award

Prestigious international honor that recognizes the best in Human Capital Management.



Brandon Hall Award

Best Competencies and Skill Development



Brandon Hall Award

Best Unique or Innovative L&D Program



Brandon Hall Award

Best Custom Content

Thinking Back

Closing Thoughts

If I Had a Second Chance

We're so crunched for time, I wish we got to get in real user testing. But too be honest, we lucked out. Everything still went smoothly. We pulled in help from the rest of the learning team to help quadruple check everything was working.